

TEACHFORNIGERIA

“Teach For Nigeria Fellowship” Evaluation Plan

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Program Description

Program background and history

Teach For Nigeria, a non-profit organization, was founded in 2017 (Teach For All, 2022). It was based on the “Teach For...” model of Teach For All (modelled after examples like Teach For India, Teach For America, etc.). Teach For Nigeria is also one of over 60 independent network organizations that make up the Teach For All Network (Mihaly et al., 2024). As an organization, they are focused on ending educational inequity for all Nigerian children.

Over the years, Teach For Nigeria has also developed other programs such as “Let Girls Thrive” an initiative focused on supporting girls’ education in underserved communities. The “Radio School” program was launched to redefine access to education for children in under-resourced communities. They also expanded their teacher training program to reach more public-school teachers, and they launched the “School Leadership Development (SLD) Program,” aimed at equipping school leaders with skills to transform education in Nigeria. Since their launch, they have mobilized 2,463 Teacher-Leaders, impacted 300,000+ students, and trained 20,000 public school teachers across 29 states in Nigeria (Teach For Nigeria, 2025).

Program description and scope

The Teach For Nigeria fellowship is a flagship initiative by Teach For Nigeria, a program that recruits and trains graduates who are then placed to teach in under-served schools during a two-year fellowship, while also committing to undertaking various community or classroom projects. To date, over 79,000 people have applied to the fellowship, and 2,965 fellows have been selected, reflecting the program's growing national visibility and competitive reach. Operating primarily in Lagos and Ogun States, TFN's fellowship is its flagship program, though the organization has expanded into complementary initiatives including a Radio School, a School Leadership Development program, an Incubation Hub for education entrepreneurs, and a teacher training program now reaching public schools in 29 states.

Vision: One day, every Nigerian child will have the opportunity to attain an excellent education.

Aims of the program:

- **Equity in education:** To deploy high-potential Nigerian graduates and professionals as full-time teachers in under-resourced, low-income public primary and secondary schools, directly addressing teacher shortages and learning deficits in communities where quality education is least accessible.
- **Leadership Development:** To equip fellows with transferable leadership skills they need to drive change beyond the classroom in the communities they serve, developing them as agents of systemic change in Nigeria's education sector and beyond.

- **Whole-child development:** To ensure students attain both academic and social-emotional learning proficiency including growth mindset, self-awareness, self-confidence, respect for others, and a heightened sense of responsibility, not merely considering exams as the metric of success.
- **Alumni movement:** To build an alumni movement that accelerates collective impact, with alumni building on their classroom teaching experience to drive long-term systemic changes within the education sector and beyond.

Evaluation needs

- **Development of a robust logic model:** TFN has clearly defined fellowship components, recruitment and selection, pre-service training, coaching, and school placement, and a formalized logical framework that traces how these inputs and activities translate into measurable short- and long-term outcomes for fellows, students, and communities remains an important area for development. Understanding the causal pathway from program activities to fellow effectiveness is essential for continuous program improvement.
- **Identification of what drives fellow effectiveness:** The RAND Corporation's two-year mixed-methods evaluation (2021–2023) established that TFN fellows produce measurable learning gains for students but did not fully identify which specific fellowship components most predict fellow effectiveness. Evaluating the relative contribution of recruitment quality, pre-service training design, coaching frequency, and school-level support to fellow development is a critical and unaddressed evaluation need.
- **Evaluation of short, medium, and long-term effectiveness:** With fellows now spanning multiple cohorts since 2017, there is an important opportunity to assess not only in-fellowship outcomes (student learning gains, fellow teaching effectiveness) but also medium-term outcomes (fellow career trajectories post-fellowship) and long-term systemic outcomes (alumni influence on education policy, school leadership, and community change). Collecting longitudinal data across cohorts would significantly strengthen TFN's evidence base.

Problem Statement

Nigeria's basic education system continues to struggle with severe gaps in access and learning quality. UNESCO Institute for Statistics data indicates that 24% of primary school-age children were out of school in 2023, reflecting the scale of the crisis at the foundational level of education (World Bank/UNESCO UIS, 2023). Concurrently, an estimated 70% of 10-year-old children in Nigeria cannot read or understand a simple text (UNICEF, 2022; NBS & UNICEF, 2022). These figures underscore an entrenched learning crisis that disproportionately affects children in low-income and rural communities across the country.

Obstacle 1: Structural Teacher Shortages and Underinvestment

A critical driver of Nigeria's education crisis is the chronic shortage of qualified teachers in public schools. Nigeria's Universal Basic Education Commission (UBEC) estimates a deficit of approximately 195,000 primary school teachers based on its 2022/2023 National Personnel Audit, with shortages concentrated in rural and underserved communities (UBEC, 2024). This is compounded by low government expenditure on education relative to comparable nations, leaving schools under-resourced and poorly equipped to attract and retain qualified educators (Macrotrends, 2025).

Obstacle 2: School-Level and Community-Level Barriers

Beyond structural underinvestment, school-level conditions significantly constrain learning outcomes. Overcrowding, poor infrastructure, and lack of technology create barriers to effective teaching and learning (Punch Newspapers, 2024). At the community level, poverty, distance, insecurity, and inadequate WASH facilities disproportionately affect girls' enrollment and retention particularly in northern states while limited parental engagement and insufficient foundational literacy support further widen learning gaps for first-generation learners (UNICEF Nigeria, 2022).

Obstacle 3: Weak School Leadership and Inadequate Pedagogical Practice.

A systematic review of evidence from low- and middle-income countries indicates that the quality of school leadership has a moderate but meaningful effect on student learning outcomes, yet principal and mid-tier management quality in Nigeria remains inconsistent (Anand et al., 2023). Nigeria's Early Grade Reading Assessment similarly revealed widespread gaps in foundational literacy, reflecting the need for structured pedagogical approaches and formative assessment practices that many public-school teachers currently lack (Federal Ministry of Education, 2021).

Teach For Nigeria's Two-Year Fellowship was designed as a direct response to these interconnected obstacles. By recruiting and training high-potential graduates as full-time teachers in under-resourced schools, TFN addresses teacher shortages in the short term while building a pipeline of future education equity leaders. The program's structured pedagogy, coaching model, and community engagement activities are designed to improve learning outcomes and foster the kind of school and community-level change that systemic education reform requires.

Previous evaluations

The most rigorous available evaluation of Teach For Nigeria is a two-year mixed-methods study conducted by the RAND Corporation between 2021 and 2023 (Mihaly, Schweig, Lin Wang, & Lee, 2024). The study found that students taught by TFN fellows outperformed comparison-group peers by 0.07 standard deviations in literacy and 0.11 standard deviations in mathematics, with second-year fellows demonstrating greater effectiveness than first-year fellows. Qualitative findings also pointed to perceived improvements in student confidence and classroom climate, though quantitative impacts on social-emotional learning outcomes were limited.

Despite its rigor, the RAND evaluation did not examine which specific fellowship components such as pre-service training design, coaching frequency, or school leadership context, most predict fellow effectiveness. This represents a critical gap for TFN's program improvement agenda. A more targeted evaluation focused on the drivers of fellow effectiveness would complement the existing evidence base, providing the actionable, component-level insights needed to strengthen TFN's recruitment, training, and coaching systems and inform the continued scaling of the fellowship model.

Constituent Engagement

The success of this evaluation relies on meaningfully involving key stakeholders across each phase of the process. This section outlines the engagement strategy for the constituent groups connected to Teach For Nigeria's Two-Year Fellowship Program, describing their roles during the evaluation strategy, data collection and analysis, and data use phases.

Engaging stakeholders such as TFN fellows, coaches and program staff, organizational leadership, host school administrators, the Board of Directors, Ogun State education authorities, funders, and students and community members ensures that the evaluation captures comprehensive, contextually grounded insights and meaningfully informs decision-making. By incorporating feedback, participation, and advocacy from these groups, the evaluation aims to generate relevant recommendations and actionable improvements to the fellowship model which will strengthen TFN's ability to develop effective teachers and leaders in Nigeria's most underserved communities.

Our proposed constituent engagement approach can be [found here](#).

Logic Model

The following section presents the logic model for the Teach For Nigeria fellowship program, illustrating its structure and pathways to achieving its intended outcomes. This model highlights the inputs, activities, and outputs that drive the program's short, medium, and long-term consequences, culminating in its broader societal impact.

By visually mapping the relationships between these components, the logic model clearly explains how the program aims to promote equitable access to education, foster leadership, and enhance social mobility.

Additionally, it incorporates vital assumptions and external influences that shape the program's implementation and evaluation. This framework is a foundation for assessing the program's effectiveness and guiding strategic improvements.

PROGRAM GOAL To develop high-potential Nigerian graduates and professionals into effective classroom teachers and equity-minded leaders who improve foundational learning outcomes in underserved schools through a long-term commitment to eliminating educational inequity in Nigeria.

INPUTS	ACTIVITIES	OUTPUTS	SHORT-TERM OUTCOMES	INTERMEDIATE OUTCOMES	LONG-TERM OUTCOMES
<i>What we invest</i>	<i>What we do</i>	<i>What we produce</i>	<i>0 – 12 months</i>	<i>1 – 2 years</i>	<i>3 – 5+ years</i>
Financial - Private grants & philanthropic donations - Ogun State govt & institutional co-funding - Teach For All network & in-kind support Human - TFN coaches, trainers & recruitment staff - Host school principals & administrators - Ogun State community partners Knowledge - Teach For All model & global best practices - RAND evaluation findings (2024) - Structured pedagogy & TaRL evidence	1. Recruitment & Selection - Targeted outreach at universities & professional networks - Multi-stage screening, interviews & leadership assessments 2. Pre-Service Training 6-week intensive training: pedagogy, classroom management & leadership - Orientation to Ogun State contexts & TFN mission 3. Coaching & Support - Ongoing instructional coaching & mentoring - Classroom observations, performance reviews & data-informed feedback 4. Leadership & Community - Structured leadership development programming - Fellow-led community engagement with school & parents	Recruitment # fellows selected & placed in Ogun State Training # completing 6-week pre-service program - Instructional toolkits & curriculum guides produced Placement # primary & secondary schools served # students reached in fellow-led classrooms Coaching # coaching visits & observations per fellow/term # performance reviews per fellow Community # fellow-led community projects implemented # alumni tracked post-program	Fellows - Increased pedagogical knowledge & classroom management skills - Improved ability to apply formative assessment strategies - Increased awareness of systemic barriers to education equity Students - Increased foundational literacy & numeracy skills - Improved classroom engagement & attendance Schools - Increased host school awareness of evidence-informed teaching approaches	Fellows - Demonstrated improvement in teaching effectiveness (Year 2 vs. Year 1) - Strengthened professional identity & equity commitment - Increased intention to pursue careers in education or social impact Students - Sustained improvements in foundational reading & mathematics - Reduced learning gaps vs. comparison peers Schools & Communities - Improved school climate & community ownership of learning - Strengthened TFN–Ogun State government relationships	Alumni - Increased proportion of alumni engaged in education, advocacy or policy post-fellowship - Alumni influence on education reform across government & civil society System-Level - Sustained availability of equity-committed teachers in underserved Ogun State schools - Measurable improvements in foundational outcomes across successive fellowship cohorts
ASSUMPTIONS High-potential graduates, if well-recruited and supported, can become effective teachers in under-resourced schools. Two years of immersive teaching cultivates both effectiveness and long-term equity commitment. School leadership support and community trust are essential enabling conditions. ENVIRONMENTAL INFLUENCES Ogun State government education policies and partnership conditions; availability of community attitudes toward externally placed teachers; Nigeria's national education reform landscape.					

Evaluation Overview

Evaluation purpose statement

The purpose of this evaluation is to determine the extent to which the two-year fellowship program of Teach For Nigeria (TFN) helps to develop high-potential graduates into impactful classroom teachers and leaders who can help to advance equity in education in underserved communities in Nigeria.

The findings will be used by internal partners such as program leaders, training and coaching staff, recruitment and selection teams to build on the effectiveness of the fellowship program, including recruitment, pre-service training, coaching, school placement, and leadership development, to determine what aspects of the program contribute the most to the effectiveness of fellows.

Findings will be shared with external partners to inform continued collaboration with state governments, to deepen relationships with public school communities, and to help inform funders and stakeholders about the role of Teach For Nigeria in addressing teacher shortages, improving foundational learning outcomes, and advancing sustainable solutions to address education challenges in Nigeria.

Evaluation questions

- A. **Context:** To what extent do TFN fellows serve in environments with the greatest scarcity of qualified teachers??
- B. **Process/Implementation:** To what extent does TFN model's fundamental elements (e.g., recruitment, pre-service training, coaching and in-school support) contribute to improving the effectiveness of TFN fellow?

Evaluation Indicators & Methods

This section outlines how the evaluation will measure progress toward Teach For Nigeria's key evaluation questions by linking each question to specific indicators and data collection methods. Drawing from the logic model and evaluation purpose, the indicators focus on both fellowship context and the program elements most closely associated with fellow effectiveness, including recruitment and selection, pre-service training, coaching, in-school support, and self-reported teaching effectiveness.

To capture these areas, the evaluation will use a mixed-methods approach that combines administrative data, the Fellow Effectiveness Survey, and key informant interviews with school administrators. Together, these methods are intended to provide both descriptive and explanatory evidence on how TFN's fellowship model is being implemented and which components appear to contribute most to fellow effectiveness.

Our proposed methods for each evaluation question and their corresponding indicators can be [found here](#)

Data Collection Instrument

This section presents the primary data collection tool for the evaluation; a structured Fellow Effectiveness Survey designed for current Teach For Nigeria fellows. The instrument is aligned to the evaluation purpose, logic model, and indicators and is intended to capture fellows' perceptions of the core fellowship components that may contribute to their effectiveness, including recruitment and selection, pre-service training, coaching, in-school support, and self-reported teaching practices.

The survey also includes background and demographic items to help interpret variation across respondents. Designed as a quantitative instrument, it provides a practical and standardized way to collect comparable data across fellows and generate evidence that can inform improvements to TFN's fellowship model.

Our proposed data collection instrument can be [found here](#)

Administration Plan

The Administration Plan section outlines the data collection methods that will be employed to evaluate the Teach For Nigeria Two-Year Fellowship Program, ensuring a systematic and efficient approach to data gathering. The methods include administrative data collection, a fellow effectiveness survey, and school administrator key informant interviews, each tailored to provide comprehensive insights into fellowship implementation and fellow effectiveness across Ogun State placement schools.

By clarifying who is responsible for each method, when data collection will take place, and the groups targeted for participation, the plan supports a thorough and well-coordinated evaluation process that respects the time and roles of all stakeholders involved.

Our proposed administration plan for each method can be [found here](#)

Data Use Plan

This section outlines how the findings from the evaluation of Teach For Nigeria's Two-Year Fellowship Program will be shared with key audiences to maximize impact and drive meaningful program improvements. By identifying the different target groups including TFN fellows, coaches and program staff, organizational leadership, host school administrators, the Board of Directors, Ogun State education authorities, and funders, the plan details the purpose of sharing findings with each. It also highlights the tools and forums that will be used for dissemination, ensuring that evaluation results reach the relevant audiences effectively, in accessible formats, and in a timely manner.

The plan emphasizes a strategic approach to communication, aligning findings with the specific goals and decision-making needs of each group and facilitating actionable recommendations that strengthen the fellowship model, deepen stakeholder partnerships, and advance TFN's long-term mission of eliminating educational inequity in Nigeria.

Our proposed data use plan for per constituent group can be [found here](#)

Limitations

The evaluation approach proposed in this plan may have some limitations that could affect how findings are interpreted and utilized, both internally within Teach For Nigeria and externally by partners, funders, and state education authorities. Attention to these elements will be essential to maximize the value of the evaluation and ensure that findings can be used effectively to inform fellowship model improvements, stakeholder engagement, and strategic decision-making.

A. **Reliance on Fellow Self-Report Data:** The Fellow Effectiveness Survey, the primary data collection instrument in this evaluation, depends entirely on fellows' self-reported perceptions of their training, coaching, and teaching effectiveness. Fellows may respond in socially desirable ways, particularly if they are uncertain about the confidentiality of their responses despite assurances provided. This limitation may affect the accuracy of findings related to coaching quality and self-reported teaching effectiveness and should be considered when interpreting survey results alongside administrative and qualitative data sources.

B. **Limited Geographic and Programmatic Scope:** This evaluation focuses exclusively on TFN fellows placed in Ogun State schools, which represents only one of TFN's primary operating locations. Findings may not fully reflect the experiences of fellows in Lagos State or other program contexts, limiting the generalizability of conclusions to TFN's broader fellowship operations. Additionally, the evaluation addresses only two of TFN's core evaluation questions, leaving other dimensions of program impact such as alumni long-term outcomes and community-level change outside the scope of this inquiry.

C. **Small Qualitative Sample and Administrator Availability:** The key informant interview component targets only four to six host school administrators, which, while appropriate for a focused qualitative inquiry, may not capture the full diversity of school-level experiences across TFN's Ogun State placement schools.

D. **Risks Associated with Untested Instruments:** The data collection instruments proposed in this evaluation have not yet been piloted within the specific context of TFN's fellowship program. Without adequate piloting, there is a risk that individual questions may be misinterpreted, indicators may not map cleanly to fellowship realities on the ground, or data collection procedures may prove inconsistent across sites.

Summary

This evaluation plan was developed to support Teach For Nigeria's ongoing efforts to strengthen its Two-Year Fellowship Program and deepen its evidence base on what drives fellow effectiveness. The plan is grounded in the organization's broader mission of addressing educational inequity in Nigeria by recruiting, training, and supporting high-potential graduates and professionals to serve as teachers and leaders in underserved schools. As described throughout the report, the fellowship model is built around several core components, including recruitment and selection, pre-service training, coaching, school placement, and leadership development, all of which are intended to contribute to stronger teaching practice and improved student outcomes over time.

A central contribution of this evaluation plan is its focus on moving beyond general program success to examine which specific elements of the fellowship model appear to contribute most to fellow effectiveness. This focus responds directly to an important gap identified in the report: while prior evidence, including the RAND evaluation, suggests that TFN fellows can generate positive student learning gains, there remains a need for more actionable evidence on the role of recruitment quality, training content, coaching support, and school-level conditions in shaping fellows' development and effectiveness. The evaluation is therefore designed not only to assess implementation, but also to generate practical insights that can inform program improvement and strategic decision-making.

The plan is also strengthened by its explicit alignment to the logic model. The selected indicators and methods reflect key parts of TFN's theory of change, especially the pathway linking program activities such as recruitment, pre-service training, and coaching to short-term fellow outcomes like pedagogical preparation, classroom management, use of formative assessment, and perceived improvement in teaching effectiveness. At the same time, the report appropriately acknowledges several limitations that should shape how the evaluation is interpreted. Most importantly, the fellow survey relies heavily on self-reported data, which may be influenced by social desirability bias or differences in how respondents interpret questions about effectiveness. The geographic focus on Ogun State also limits generalizability to other TFN contexts, especially Lagos State.

Generally, this evaluation plan provides a solid foundation for a focused and useful inquiry into the implementation and effectiveness of Teach For Nigeria's fellowship model. It is especially well positioned to support internal learning by helping TFN identify where the fellowship model is strongest, where fellows may need more targeted support, and which program elements should be prioritized for refinement. Just as importantly, the plan establishes a structure for sharing findings with multiple audiences, including fellows, staff, leadership, government partners, and funders, in ways that are relevant to each group's decisions.

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